FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of October 18–24, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation
In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — John 8:31–32
"So Jesus said to the Jews who had believed Him, "If you abide in My word, you are truly My disciples, and you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.""

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: Deuteronomy 17:1–20; Matthew 14:1–21
Mon: Deuteronomy 18:1–22; Matthew 14:22–36
Tue: Deuteronomy 19:1–20; Matthew 15:1–20
Wed: Deuteronomy 20:1–20; Matthew 15:21–39
Thu: Deuteronomy 21:1–23; Matthew 16:1–12
Fri: Deuteronomy 24:10—25:10; Matthew 16:13–28
Sat: Deuteronomy 25:17—26:19; Matthew 17:1–13

Talk About It This Week
Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)
✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Before You, Lord, We Bow" — LSB 966
Before You, Lord, we bow, / Our God who reigns above / And rules the world below, / Boundless in pow'r and love. / Our thanks we bring / In joy and praise, / Our hearts we raise / To You, our King!

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction
Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Twenty-first Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 24) October 18, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 121:1–4, 7–8; antiphon: v. 5*

The LORD is your keeper;
the LORD is your shade on your right hand.
I lift up my eyes to the hills.
From where does my help come?
My help comes from the LORD,
who made heaven and earth.
He will not let your foot be moved;
he who keeps you will not slumber.
Behold, he who keeps Israel
will neither slumber nor sleep.
The LORD will keep you from all evil;
he will keep your life.
The LORD will keep your going out and your coming in
from this time forth and forevermore.
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
The LORD is your keeper;
the LORD is your shade on your right hand.

Collect of the Day

O God, the protector of all who trust in You, have mercy on us that with You as our ruler and guide we may so pass through things temporal that we lose not the things eternal; through Jesus Christ, Your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Isaiah 45:1–7 · Psalm 96:1–9 (10–13) · 1 Thessalonians 1:1–10 · Matthew 22:15–22

Gradual *Psalm 91:11; 103:1*

For he will command his angels concerning you
to guard you in all your ways.
Bless the LORD, O my soul,
and all that is within me, bless his holy name!

Next Sunday's Readings (Reformation (Observed))

Revelation 14:6–7 · Psalm 46 · Romans 3:19–28 · Matthew 11:12–19 or John 8:31–36

Learn by Heart: The Second Commandment *LSB p. 321*

"You shall not misuse the name of the Lord your God. What does this mean? We should fear and love God so that we do not curse, swear, use satanic arts, lie, or deceive by His name, but call upon it in every trouble, pray, praise, and give thanks."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: They try to trap Him with a coin. Jesus asks whose image is on it, and when they say Caesar's, He tells them to give Caesar back what already bears his likeness. The question He leaves hanging is the real one: whose image do you carry? Ask one another: "What belongs to God because it bears His likeness — and are we handing it over?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is the "Offering"?

The Offering is the time in the service when we offer gifts to God along with the rest of the congregation. It is concluded with the Offertory, the song sung while the gifts are brought to the altar.

Everything we have is already a gift from God. When we give an offering we are saying thank You — for life, food, family, and most of all our Savior. This Sunday Jesus holds up a coin and asks whose picture is on it. Ask whose picture is on you.

Parents: *Before the service, remind your children what giving means. Help them think of all they have and how it is really God's gift. Encourage them to set aside some of their own money each week to give.*

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